

Firearms Trace Data: Maryland - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Contents

1. [ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer](#)
2. Table: [Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Maryland in Calendar Year 2023](#)
3. Table: [Firearm Types with a Maryland Recovery](#)
4. Table: [Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Maryland Recovery](#)
5. Table: [Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Maryland Recovery](#)
6. Table: [Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery](#)
7. Table: [Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery](#)
8. Table: [Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery](#)
9. Table: [Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery](#)
10. [Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics](#)

ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Maryland in Calendar Year 2023

10,332

Firearm Types with a Maryland Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	6,791
Rifles	1,534
Shotguns	1,046
Revolvers	781
Receivers/Frames	84
Machinegun Conversion Devices	36
Derringers	25
Machineguns	11
Other*	24

* Other includes Unknown Types, Combinations, Destructive Devices, Any Other Weapons, Silencers and a Flare Gun.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Maryland Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	4,239
.40 Cal	932
12GA	826

.22 Cal	825
.45 Cal	565
.380 Cal	404
.38 Cal	301
5.56mm	245
.357 Cal	187
MULTI	167

NOTE: There were 1,401 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 240 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Maryland Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	3,676
Possession of Weapon	1,906
Family Offense	1,260
Health - Safety	1,011
Weapon Offense	427
Aggravated Assault	316
Found Firearm	263
Homicide	198
Dangerous Drugs	182
Simple Assault	162

NOTE: There were 931 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Maryland	3,252
Virginia	1,020
Georgia	507
Pennsylvania	330
North Carolina	293
South Carolina	264
West Virginia	231
Florida	177
Ohio	143
Delaware	140
Texas	111
District of Columbia	100
Alabama	76
Tennessee	72
Kentucky	62

NOTE: An additional 35 states and Puerto Rico accounted for 500 other traces. The source state was identified in 7,278 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	290
3 Months to Under 7 Months	330
7 Months to Under 1 Year	389
1 Year to Under 2 Years	901
2 Years to Under 3 Years	936
3 Years and Over	4,318

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Maryland Average Time-to-Crime: **8.98 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	386
18 to 21	906
22 to 24	691
25 to 30	1,300
31 to 40	2,078
41 to 50	1,227
Over 50	1,323

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Maryland Average Age of Possessor: **36 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Baltimore	2,850
Hagerstown	307
Hyattsville	292
Silver Spring	284
Frederick	281
Oxon Hill	273
Waldorf	216
Westminster	209
Glen Burnie	198
Temple Hills	196

NOTE: There were 280 additional municipalities that accounted for 5,054 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 172 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Maryland. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Maryland.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Maryland Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Maryland Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Maryland Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024